

the default format is Quicktime MOV, MPEG-4 (MP4/M4V), Material eXchange Format (MXF) and Audio Video Interleave (AVI). Each of these formats has its pros and cons, with the Quicktime MOV finding itself to be the most widely compatible with most editing systems.



Professional editors use a separate highly customised console unit for their non-linear editing which offers speed and control.

If you're using high-end professional range cameras that shoot in RAW format such as those from RED and ARRI you will end up with REDCODE RAW (R3D) and ARRIRAW formats respectively. Not all editing applications come with the codecs necessary to edit these formats and you may need to undergo additional installation or conversion of plug-ins to make them work.

Organisation of Media

Once your project is correctly setup you are ready to begin editing. The initial bits may be boring as you have to neatly organise your footage to the editing environment's media panel. In most cases this panel is known as the Bin and you can keep your footage arranged here for use as you continue editing. It helps on a long project to organise your shots in sets of which scenes they are a part of in subfolders so you don't have to hunt too long for specific clips. Good organisation can save lots of time and effort.

The capturing part of footage i.e. the transfer from camera or card to the software is not covered because it can vary radically depending on many factors. But for most DSLRs you can simply drag and drop the footage from the card to your hard disk and then into the Bin of the editing software. Be careful with non-Quicktime footage since some of it needs to be imported using the options in the menu bar since some cameras record video and audio separately which is linked together by metadata that can only be read by transfer software.

Three Point Editing Workflow and Shortcuts

Once your footage is neatly organised you can begin editing. This is where